Power Automate Foundation



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Exercise 1 · Find a bottleneck



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Your learning day

Time	Activity	Work mode
09:00–10:30	Find a bottleneck	Group mapping
10:30–10:45	Break	
10:45–12:00	Flow-card challenges	Group simulation
12:00–13:00	Lunch	
13:00–14:30	Build an email flow	Individual build
14:30–14:45	Break	
14:45–16:00	Design a simple flow with AI	Design only / Q&A

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Your outputs

A clear map

Five training-request steps and responsible roles

One improvement

A small change with a human check

A working email

Two received messages matching two inputs

A flow design

Text diagram, build guidance and a fictional walkthrough

Predict → Try → Check

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What is automation?

Automation follows a defined sequence of steps to carry out repeatable work.



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What matters in automation?

With a clear recipe, which steps can repeat?

Who checks a special request?

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People check special requests

Routine steps follow agreed rules.
A person checks special requests and the final result.



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Repeatable work



Suitable for a rule

Copy agreed information
Send a standard request
Route to a known role



Needs human judgement

Choose the right information
Resolve an unclear exception
Check the business result

A recipe repeats steps; a person chooses the meal and checks the result.

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People remain responsible

A flow follows the instructions you configure.

A person chooses the requested item and recipient.

A person decides whether a request is approved.

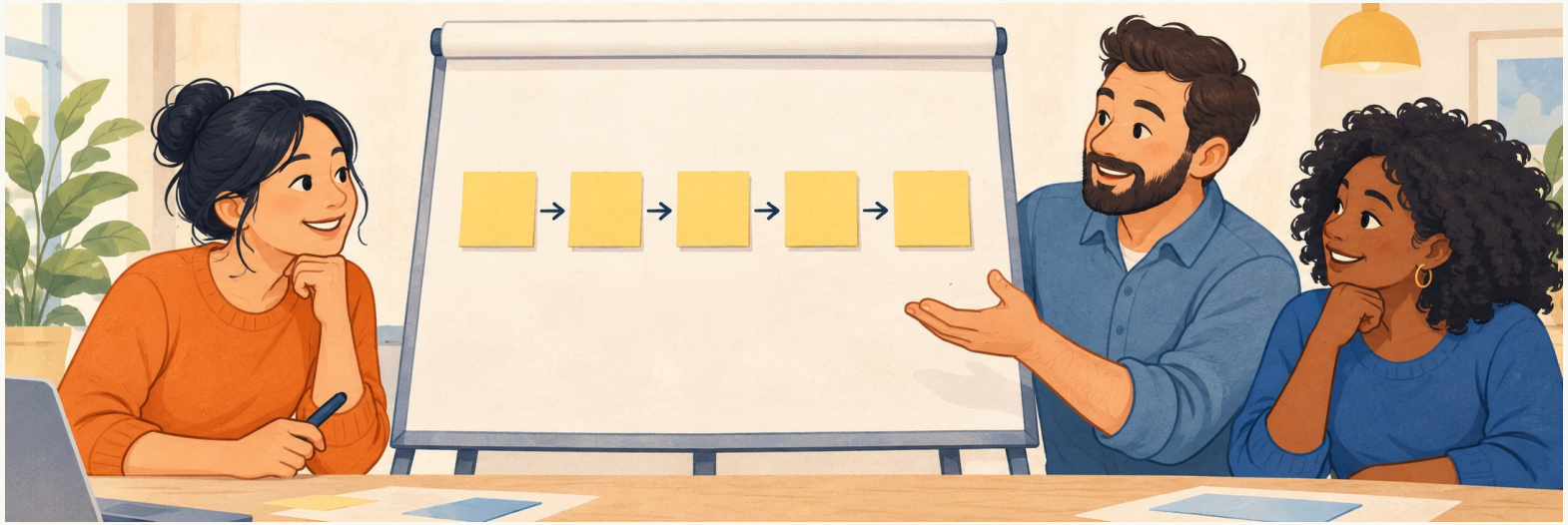
A person checks whether the output fits the intended purpose.



Automation supports a process owner’s decisions.

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The training request



Submit details → Check required details → Record request → Approve or reject → Notify requester

Add role labels in Practice 2.

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Match the roles



Which role belongs under each step?



Requester



Coordinator



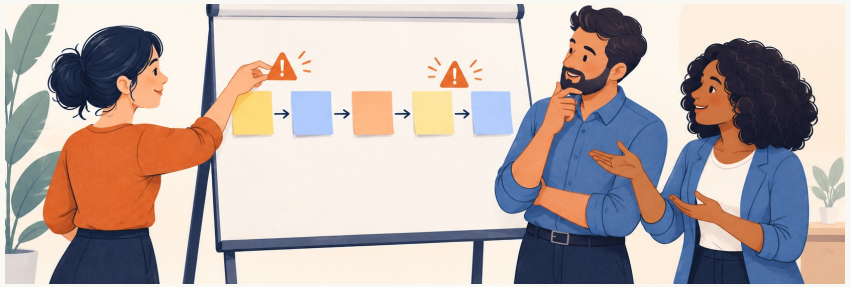
Manager

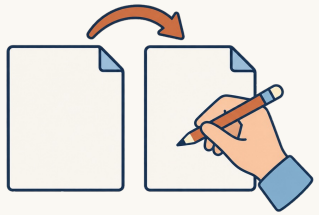
Add a role to each step. Reuse roles where needed.

Explain what information passes to the next step.

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Four kinds of friction











Repeated work

Copying training details again

Waiting

Waiting for a decision

Missing details

Topic, date, count or reason missing

Unclear ownership

Unclear follow-up owner

Mark at least two bottlenecks and explain their causes.

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One small improvement



The system could support

Reuse a missing-details message
Reduce repeated register copying

The person still checks

Check information and recipient
Manager approves or rejects

Name the checking role. Keep the change small.

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Invite the Inquisitor

Give another team a friendly review.

1. Choose one Inquisitor and visit another group.
2. Host team: explain the improvement and human checkpoint.
3. Ask one question; sign after a clear explanation.
4. If unclear, invite a retry. Welcome a visitor to your team.



Break 10:30–10:45 · Return for the card game.

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Exercise 2 · Play the Flow-card challenges



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Trigger, Action and Control



Trigger

The event that starts the flow

Action

A task the flow performs

Control

A choice of path or repeated steps

Connect the start to a useful outcome.

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Work together



Read

Discuss the scenario



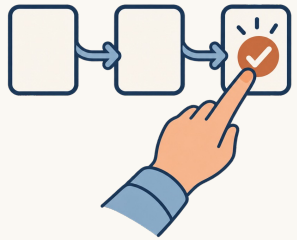
Arrange

Try the cards together



Explain

Everyone can contribute



Check

Trace the normal result

Take turns moving the cards.

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Six Flow-card challenges

Challenge	Normal result
1 · Email attachment intake	Save both attachments
2 · Monthly review and approval	Notify the team after approval
3 · Field-support request routing	Pass the complete request
4 · Internal resource approval	Tell Operations after approval
5 · Teams service-request routing	Send the request to Service Queue
6 · Controlled-document approval	Create the approved copy

Start with 4 or 5 if unsure. Completing all six is optional.

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One point for a basic flow

Maximum score: 6 points

Use a valid starting Trigger and connected supplied cards.

Explain how the normal case reaches its required result.

Hints and retries have no deductions.

Each challenge counts once; no speed bonuses.



Exception discussions are optional and do not affect points.

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Exercise 3 · Build an email flow



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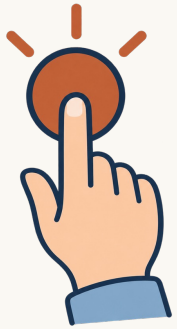
One missing item, one reusable request

Find a missing report item → Choose item and recipient → Run the email flow → Check the request email

A separate scenario uses the same method to reduce repeated typing.

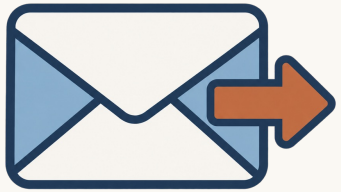
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Trigger, Action and Connector



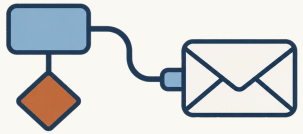
Trigger

Manually trigger a flow
Starts when you run it



Action

Send an email (V2)
Sends the configured message



Connector

Office 365 Outlook
Provides the mailbox operation

Each operation still needs an approved connection and access.

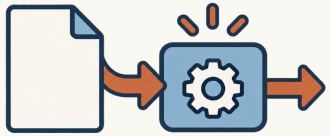
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Three cloud-flow types



Instant

A person starts it
Today's individual build



Automated

An event starts it
Example: a form response



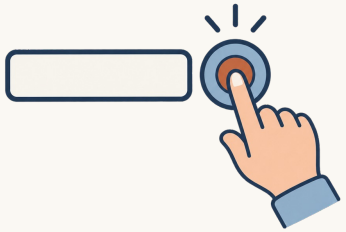
Scheduled

A time starts it
Example: a monthly review

Today you build an Instant cloud flow.

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The smallest useful flow





Manually trigger a flow
RequestedItem

→

Office 365 Outlook
Send an email (V2)

Save stores the instructions. Run sends a real training email.

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Practice 1 · Create the manual trigger

B3-MyInformationRequest

Flow

Create → Instant cloud flow
Manually trigger a flow

Input

Add an input → Text
RequestedItem · required



Checkpoint: exactly one required Text input.

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Practice 2 · Insert Dynamic content

To Your own work email · CC/BCC empty

Subject [TRAINING] Information request for weekly report

Body

Hello,

Please provide: **[RequestedItem token]**
This information is for the weekly report.
If it is not ready, please tell me the expected delivery date.

Thank you.
This is a training message.



Checkpoint: the flow saves with the token in Body.

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Practice 3 · Test input A

Input **List of outstanding tasks**

Expected email **Please provide: List of outstanding tasks**

Predict the request line.

Test → Manually → Test; confirm your own connection if prompted.

Run once, then check Run history and the received email.

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Test input B and compare

Input

Expected completion date



Expected email

Please provide: Expected completion date

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Optional Practice 4 · Follow-up task

Manual start → Send email → Create To Do task

After Tests A and B succeed, with To Do access and time available.

Microsoft To-Do (Business): Add a to-do (V3)

To-do List: B3 Practice

Title: type “Follow up: ” + insert RequestedItem

Run once. Check the additional email and matching task.

Optional. Leave dates/reminders unset. Every run creates another email and task.

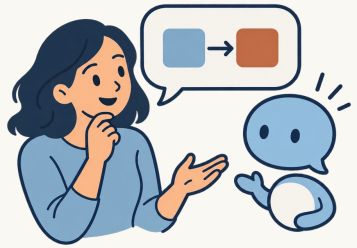
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Exercise 4 · Design a simple flow with AI



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An approved learning coach





Helpful use

Describe a simple scenario
Explain the proposed steps
Suggest build guidance

Your responsibility

Protect private information
Evaluate the advice
Check the design and assumptions

Design only. Use fictional text and an organisation-approved app.

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Three everyday scenarios

Office supplies	Form request: notify the coordinator and confirm receipt to the requester.
Weekly reminder	Monday morning: email the team and post the same reminder in Teams.
Document notification	New practice file: notify the coordinator and team using the file name.

Choose one. Weekly reminder is the suggested starting choice.

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Practice 1 · Describe your scenario

1. Set up the coach

Start a new approved AI chat.
Paste the coach setup prompt first.
Ask for a simple, unverified design.

2. Send one scenario

Use one supplied beginner prompt.
Keep the same chat for follow-ups.
Check one Trigger and 2–3 Actions.

One straight path. No branches, loops, approvals or AI actions.

Copy the full setup and scenario prompts from Exercise 4.

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Practice 2 · Explore how to build it

Follow-up 1: build guidance

“Show me the steps and main fields. What would I type, and what would I insert from an earlier step?”

Follow-up 2: a fictional walkthrough

“Walk through one example. What should happen, and what should I check with my instructor or IT team?”

Read the guidance only. Full prompts are on the website.

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A diagram made from plain text

```
[Trigger: Schedule]
Recurrence: Monday morning
          |
          v
[Action 1: Outlook]
Send reminder email
          |
          v
[Action 2: Teams]
Post reminder in channel
```

Text works without image rendering

Use brackets, | and v.
Keep a narrow vertical layout.
Put it in a plain-text code block.
Avoid Mermaid, HTML and images.

Instructor-authored example. Design only, not built or tested.

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Practice 3 · Check and explain your design

1. Count the steps	One Trigger and two or three Actions. A single path without branches or loops.
2. Trace one example	Explain each input, Action and output. Check recipients and destinations.
3. Name a future check	Identify one access or setup requirement. Ask the instructor about unclear advice.

Label your result: Design only — not built or tested.

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Questions and your next step

Choose one small workplace idea to explore.

Which repeated step could benefit from a clearer rule?

Who would check the input, recipient and result?

What access or policy needs confirmation?

What is your next practical step?

Q&A 15:40–15:55 · Personal next step 15:55–16:00

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